Minutes for the February 11, 2026 Vietnam Veterans Of America, Chapter 279 Meeting

The regular meeting of Chapter 279 was called to order by President Hester at 1830 hours. After the salute to the American flag, President Hester led the Pledge of Allegiance. Chaplain Dwain Holmes led the Chapter in prayer. His email is tukupholmes@gmail.com. His phone # is 402-999-1108.

Roll Call of Officers: President Hester, VP Mangiamelli, Treasurer Haase, Secretary Halbkat. There are 4 officers and 40 members present. We have a quorum.

Guest Speaker: None

New Members: None

Sick Call: Ron Dupell and Jim Kjosa. Get well, guys. We want to see you at the meetings.

Presidents Report: Quilts of Valor Ceremony will be held at the Post honoring 4 chapter members. In March, I will send out an email to see how many members and spouses will attend. On March 29, 2026 we will be honoring Vietnam Veterans Day. A ceremony will be held at 2PM at Papillion Landing. Then we will go to the National Memorial for the finish. If the weather is bad, we will stay at the Landing for the entire Ceremony. Our golf outing will be held at same place this year. Will be sending out email looking for volunteers. It will format same as last one. 36 teams with lots of prizes. We will need lots of volunteers. I will be sending out the VVA poem we read at funerals. Last, but not least, we will shortly be thinking about the parade schedule---coming up fast.

Secretary Report: Emailed to all members. George Abbott moved to accepted as written and Dwain Holmes seconded. Motion passed.

Treasurer Report: Treasurer Haase explained all entries of the report to the chapter. There being no corrections, VP Mangiamelli made motion to accept as written and Bill Robinson seconded. Motion passed. There were some bills to be paid: $470.00 to State Council for partial rent of storage space, and $100.00 for upkeep to the website. Mike Steffan made motion to accept and Jim Quick seconded the motion. Motion passed.

Scholarships: Tom Brown read a letter dated January 26, 2026 thanking Chapter 279 for the investment we have made for 4 students in their studies at UNL.

Veterans Home Board: Tom Brown reports of the 120 applications the board has received, 90% have been accepted.

Correspondence Report: Joe Mangiamelli reports Buena Vista school is looking for speakers for their JRROTC program.

Veterans Court: Eddie Nelson reports all is looking well with program.

National VVA Delegate: Dottie Barickman reports that National is on revenue sharing for the next year. The 2027 budget has been made for that year. She also reports that our VVA Foundation is looking to 2027 as the year to commence work for a new education center at our Memorial.

Homeless Veterans: No Report

Chapter Membership Report: President Hester reports 223 members and 12 associates.

POW/MIA: Ron Haase reports currently 1566

Old Business: Greg Kleve gave the chapter an update on the move of the Legion Post

Please check out the chapter's webpage---nebraskavietnamveterans.com

Next Meeting: Wednesday, March 11, 2026, at 1830 hours, located at the Millard Legion Post 374.

Motion to adjourn was made by Ed Boller and seconded by Dick Rowe. Motion passed.

Submitted by:

Tom Halbkat, Secretary